8.9 Hypothyroidism

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I feel cold, tired and slow." **Objective** • TSH high, T4 low • Putting on weight • Skin dry	**ACTUAL** **Fatigue** related to decreased metabolic rate as evidenced by tiredness and slowness.	Within weeks of treatment, more energy.	• Give levothyroxine in the morning on an empty stomach. • Explain that treatment is lifelong and TSH needs checking regularly. • Plan rest.	More energy: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I have not opened my bowels for 4 days." **Objective** • Bowel sounds reduced • Stools hard	**ACTUAL** **Constipation** related to slowed GI motility as evidenced by infrequent stools.	Within 3 days, soft bowel movements regularly.	• Encourage fluids and fibre. • Encourage activity as she can manage. • Give the laxative as prescribed.	Regular: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • HR 52/min • Elderly	**RISK** **Risk for decreased cardiac output** as evidenced by risk factors: bradycardia and myxedema.	HR and BP stable.	• No sedatives. • In older or cardiac patients, start thyroxine at a low dose as ordered. • Report chest pain.	Stable: **goal met**.